

AN INTRO TO COLD

TO THE UNINITIATED, THE CRAFTING OF A BASIC COLD Circle may appear deceptively simple—after all, even apprentices can trace a crude mimicry of it in frost upon their study tables. Yet few possess the finesse of mind required to bind the four essential glyphs—Water, Element, Dense, and Pressure—into a harmonious weave. Many a lesser scholar has attempted this and produced nothing more than a damp chill or, worse, an embarrassing puff of fog. I, however, have refined the art to perfection through countless hours of experimentation and only a handful of regrettable incidents involving ruptured flasks and a briefly frozen familiar.

The key, as I have long maintained, lies not in detail but in dominance over the symbols themselves. The glyphs must know who commands them. When I first succeeded in condensing vapor into a solid sphere of ice midair, I realized that true mastery comes from authority, not caution. Still, I would urge the reader—particularly those of delicate constitution—to observe moderation when invoking Pressure and Dense simultaneously. The last apprentice who disregarded my warnings now answers to the name “Icicle,” though he insists that his hands will thaw eventually.

—Thalen Quorren, *The Fundamentals of Circlecraft*

